



TIMELESS ECHOES
(clockwise from left) The sandstone walls form a solid massing, with deep openings; pre-independence wooden remnants of a chariot find new life as art in the formal living; at the heart of the home lies a landscaped courtyard



Design should centre on creating spaces that breathe, heal and tell a story. When two doctors approached us to design their 7,800 sq ft sanctuary at the edge of Bangalore, the mandate was clear yet profound. They sought a revitalising refuge that could seamlessly house the numerous treasures they had collected over a lifetime. Anchored by lush greenery and opening directly onto a golf course, the residence was conceived with well-being as its chief design intent. Drenched in natural light and optimised for ventilation, the finishes are made of stone and lime plaster. It stands today as a peaceful sanctuary of strength and grace, nodding gently to the endurance of traditional craft and raw material honesty.

The Serendipity of Salvaged Stone

The distinct visual identity of the home exterior began with an unexpected detour in Jaipur. While searching for antiques with the clients, we stumbled upon a Gwalior Mint quarry where discarded slabs lay cast aside. While the quarry yard had disregarded these pieces due to natural colour variations, my eye was immediately drawn to the incredible grain and character of this imperfect stone. Recognising its irreplaceable spirit, we chose this rescued material over traditional artifacts. We left the stone entirely untreated and each slab was meticulously hand-chipped on-site. This raw, honest skin now wraps the entire exterior of the house, grounding the architecture in an authentic, textured and deeply tactile presence.

Integrating History into Living Walls

Inside the home, artifacts and antiques are never treated as static showpieces. Instead, they are integrated as symbiotic companions that heighten the atmosphere and define the spatial intent. At the main entrance, two 50-year-old earthen granary pots frame the arrival with a sculptural presence, giving the threshold a quiet weight of memory. Moving inside, the foyer is anchored by a majestic five-foot-tall Nataraja statue. By mounting it securely within a custom scooped recess in the wall, the statue is woven directly into the architectural skin. This deliberate embedding transforms everyday objects into functional spatial devices that punctuate walls, mark transitions and mediate scale.